

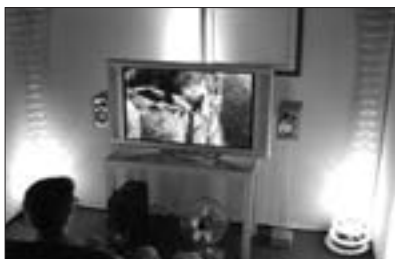
7.4 Games Onward

No matter what happens to the technology involved in gaming or the enhancements in the graphics and hardware department, one thing will remain the same—the storyline. A racing game will always need you to reach the chequered flag before your opponents do. A game such as *Counter-Strike* will always require you to kill infiltrators or terrorists.

What will change are the game formats and the machine's rendering capabilities—development in the games of the future will depend on the advances made by the hardware.

Companies such as Philips are working on technologies that will be able to control lights, heaters, fans, audio, video and even gaming-related 'furniture', all in order to heighten the gaming experience. Philips plans to launch a technology called amBX as early as May 2006. The company claims amBX will revolutionise the way people play and experience games.

"The treacherous road to Saigon will turn your room jungle green, swimming with dolphins will splash it deep blue, Halo jumps will turn your fans on full, lightning storms will strobe your white lighting, and attack ships on fire off the shoulder of Orion will blast on your heaters." Let's hope they manage to put the brakes in the right places and don't toss us off our chairs!



Philips' amBX is set to change the way people play games

Apart from innovations in hardware and the ambience, the future of gaming will be influenced by advances in soft components such as AI and the much-maligned Emotion Engine, among